C: READING

Time permitted: 60 minutes
Number of questions: 40

Directions: *In this section you will read FOUR different passages. Each one is followed by 10 questions about it. For questions 1-40, you are to choose the best answer A, B, C or D, to each question. Then, on your answer sheet, find the number of the question and fill in the space that corresponds to the letter of the answer you have chosen. Answer all questions following a passage on the basis of what is stated or implied in that passage.*
You have 60 minutes to answer all the questions, including the time to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

PASSAGE 1 – Questions 1-10

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is the main political and economic organization for that area. The leaders summit is their last meeting before the launch of the ASEAN Economic Community, or AEC, on December 31.

The AEC will be equivalent to the world's seventh largest economy. **It** was set up to create a highly competitive single market and production area. Organizers hope it will ease the movement of capital, goods, investment, services and skilled labor across ASEAN countries. The goal is to make the whole area more competitive and economically successful. But, some business leaders have low expectations for the ASEAN summit. Anthony Nelson is a director at the US – ASEAN Business Council in Washington. He believes that security will be an important issue at the meetings, especially after the terrorist attacks in Paris last week.

"The November summit includes the East Asia Summit, which primarily focuses on political and security issues. So that's going to be a big part of what is actually going on around the summit. A lot of the work that business gets really involved in tends to happen around the ASEAN economic ministers' meeting in August." But, the AEC may have only limited influence on business activity when it comes into being next year. Experts expect little to change at first because there is still much to be done.

"The ASEAN single window, which is a customs project, is still very much a work in progress. But beginning next year they will start limited trials with five of the 10 ASEAN countries. And there have been past mutual recognition agreements for **credentials** of skilled professionals. But there's still a lot of work to be done in terms of actually **implementing** those agreements." Some critics say the AEC will mainly help businesses, not the majority of people in Southeast Asia. Earlier this year, the ASEAN Civil Society Conference and ASEAN Peoples' Forum expressed concern about regional economic **integration**. In a statement, the group said such a move would mean unequal and unsustainable economic growth. This, it said, would result "in worsening poverty and inequalities of wealth." Jerald Joseph is co – chair of the ASEAN People's Forum. He says people crossing borders to find employment need more protections. He said: "Cross – border migrant workers don't have the same level of protection or interest in the whole negotiation. So that's a little bit of a pity, a wasted chance, if it's not reflected in the coming document." The 27th ASEAN Summit includes the organization's partners. Nations including China, India, Japan and the United States are to attend.

1. ASEAN is the main political and economic organization in.....
   A. East Asia B. Southeast Asia C. West Asia D. North Asia

2. What does the word **"It"** in paragraph 2 refer to?
   A. ASEAN B. Organizer C. AEC D. Business Council

3. According to Anthony Nelson, what is the important issue at the meetings?
   A. Security B. Climate change C. Business D. Economy

4. According to the passage, what aspect tends to happen around the ASEAN economic ministers?

A. Security B. Climate change C. Business D. Economy

5. According to the passage, how many countries in the ASEAN will start limited trials?

A. 3 B. 5 C. 7 D. 10

6. The word **"credentials"** in line 19 can be replaced by

A. letters B. salutations C. invitations D. certificates

7. The word **"implementing"** in line 20 is closest in meaning to

A. carrying out B. producing C. concentrating D. focusing

8. The word **"integration"** in line 23 can be replaced by

A. utilization B. contribution C. combination D. separation

9. According to the passage, what would delay the increase of the economy?

A. the recession B. the poverty C. the move D. the employment

10. According to the passage, who require more assurance?

A. travellers B. immigrants C. residents D. tourists

PASSAGE 2 – Questions 11-20

In 1969, a key milestone in space travel was reached when Neil Armstrong set foot on the moon. In 2001, another landmark event took place when the first civilian traveled into space as a paying tourist. As a teenager, Dennis Tito dreamed of visiting outer space. As a young man, he aspired to become an astronaut and earned a bachelor's and a master's degree in aerospace engineering. However, Tito did not have all the qualities necessary to become a professional astronaut; so instead, he went to work as a space engineer in one of NASA's laboratories for five years. Later, Tito set up his own financial investment company and, eventually, he became a multi – millionaire. Later in life, the ex – rocket engineer, still passionate about space travel, began looking into ways to make a trip into space.

In the early 1990s, the Soviet Space Agency was offering tickets for a visit to the Mir space station to anyone who could afford it. Tito jumped at the chance for this once – in – a – lifetime experience. Due to political and economic changes in the former Soviet Union, however, Tito's trip was postponed and later, Mir was decommissioned. In 2001, Tito's dream was finally came true when he paid a rumored $20 million and took off aboard a SOYUZ rocket to deliver supplies to the International Space Station, a joint venture between the space agencies of Japan, Canada, Europe, Russia, and the U.S.

In preparation for the trip, Tito trained at the Gagarin Cosmonauts Training Center at Star City in Russia. There, he underwent eight months of physical fitness training, weightless simulations, and a variety of other exercises to prepare him for space travel. Although the Russians believed that Tito was adequately prepared for the trip, NASA thought otherwise. Dennis Tito had to sign an agreement with international space officials taking financial responsibility for any equipment he damaged or broke on his trip. He was also barred from entering any part of the space station owned by the U.S. unless escorted.

Although Tito made history and paved the way for the future of space tourism, factors such as cost, and the amount of training required, stand in the way of space vacations becoming an option for most people in the near future. In spite of this, Japanese and North American market data shows that there is definite public interest in space travel. In a 1993 survey of 3,030 Japanese, 80 percent of those under the age of forty said they would like to visit space at least once. Seventy percent of this group would pay up to three month's salary for the trip. In 1995, 1,020 households in North America were surveyed and of those, 60 percent were interested were under forty years of age. Just over 45 percent said they

would pay three month's salary, around 18 percent said they would pay six month's salary, and nearly 11 percent would pay a year's salary. Two – thirds of those who want to visit space would like to do so several times. Since the nature of this type of travel makes it hazardous to humans, it would have to be restricted to those who are physically fit and able to take responsibility for the risks involved.

11. According to the passage, what was the main event in 1969?
    A. Scientists planned to travel to space.
    B. People started to concern space travel.
    C. The dream of space travel became true.
    D. Neil Armstrong was ready for heading to the moon.

12. When did Dennis Tito dream of becoming an astronaut?
    A. When he was at kindergarten. B. When he was at primary school.
    C. When he was at his teen. D. When he was at university.

13. Dennis Tito made the first trip as a space tourist_____
    A. in the late '60s. B. in the early '90s. C. this century. D. in the late '50s.

14. Which of the following is NOT true about Dennis Tito?
    A. He has an advanced degree in aerospace engineering.
    B. He is now an astronaut for NASA.
    C. He eventually became a very wealthy man.
    D. He used to dream of travelling to outer space.

15. Tito's first trip into space was with_____ to_____.
    A. the Russian/ the International Space Station.
    B. the Americans/SOYUZ
    C. members of the former Soviet Union/ the Mir space station
    D. the Japanese agency

16. Which of the following describes NASA's feelings about Tito's trip into space?
    A. extremely proud B. somewhat eager C. very concerned D. disappointed

17. According to Japanese survey, which of the following is true?
    A. Eighty percent of all those interviewed would be interested in travelling to space.
    B. Some people would pay a quarter of their annual salary to visit space.
    C. Only people under the age of forty are interested in space travel.
    D. Seventy percent of Japanese would pay three quarters of their annual salary to visit space.

18. According to a North American survey on space travel, which is true?
    A. Seventy – five percent of those surveyed would be interested in travelling to space.
    B. Most people would pay a year's salary to visit space as a tourist.
    C. Most of the people interested in space travel were under the age of forty.
    D. Nearly sixty percent of those surveyed were interested in a vacation in space travel.

19. According to the passage, who did not believe that Tito was trained well enough for the trip to space?
    A. Russian Training Center. B. Japanese Training Center.
    C. European Training Center. D. NASA

20. Which of the following would probably prevent you from becoming a space tourist in the near future?

A. health B. wealth C. youth D. age

PASSAGE 3 – Questions 21-30

During the **heyday** of the railroads, when America's rail system provided the bulk of the country's passenger and freight transportation, various types of railroad cars were in service to accomplish the varied tasks handled by the railroads. One type of car that was not available for public use prior to the Civil War, however, was a sleeping car; ideas for sleeping cars abounded at the time, but these ideas were unworkable. It unfortunately took the death of a president to make the sleeping car a viable reality.

Cabinet – maker George M. Pullman had recognized the demand for sleeping cars and had worked on developing experimental models of sleeping cars in the decade leading up to the Civil War. However, in spite of the fact that he had made successful test runs on the Chicago and Alton Railroads with his models, he was unable to sell his idea because his models were too wide and too high for existing train station and bridges. In 1863, after spending time working as a storekeeper in a Colorado mining town, he invested his savings of twenty thousand dollars, a huge fortune at that time and all the money that he had in the world, in a luxurious sleeping car that he named the Pioneer. Pullman and friend Ben Field built the Pioneer on the site of the present – day Chicago Union Station. For two years, however; the Pioneer sat on a railroad siding, useless because it could not fit through train stations and over bridges.

Following President Lincoln's assassination in 1865, the state of Illinois, Lincoln's birthplace, wanted to transport the presidential casket in the finest fashion possible. The Pullman Pioneer was the most elegant car around; in order to make the Pullman part of the presidential funeral train in its run from Springfield to Chicago, the state cut down station platforms and raised bridges in order to accommodate the luxurious railway car. The Pullman car greatly impressed the funeral party, which included Lincoln's successor as president, General Ulysses S. Grant, and Grant later requested the Pioneer for a trip from Detroit to Chicago. To satisfy Grant's request for the Pioneer, the Michigan Central Railroad made improvements on its line to accommodate the wide car, and soon other railroads followed. George Pullman founded the Pullman Palace Car Company in partnership with financier Andrew Carnegie and eventually became a millionaire.

Pullman cars were normally a dark "Pullman green", although some were painted in the host railroad's colors. The cars carried individual names, but usually did not carry visible numbers. In the 1920s, the Pullman Company went through a series of restructuring steps, which in the end resulted in a parent company, Pullman incorporated, controlling the Pullman Company (which owned and operated sleeping cars) and the Pullman – Standard Car Manufacturing Company.

21. Which of the following best states the main idea of the passage?

A. America's railroads used to provide much of the country's transportation.
B. President Lincoln's assassination in 1865 shocked the nation.
C. George Pullman was the only one to come up with the idea for a sleeping car.
D. Pullman's idea for a sleeping car became workable after Lincoln's death.

22. A "**heyday**" in line 1 is most probably a .....

A. time for harvest. B. a period with low prices.
C. a period of great success. D. a type of railroad schedule.

23. It can be inferred from the passage that before the Civil War, sleeping cars .....

A. were used abundantly. B. were thought to be a good idea.
C. were only used privately. D. were used by presidents.

24. What is the main idea of paragraph 2?

A. Pullman had been successful in selling his sleeping cars.

B. Though Pullman had been successful in test runs with his sleeping cars model; it could not be suitable with the transportation in Chicago.

C. Pullman had recognized the demand for sleeping cars.

D. Pullman had invested much money on developing the sleeping cars.

25. What was the initial problem that made Pullman's card unusable?

A. They were too large. B. They were too expensive.

C. They were too slow. D. They were too unusual.

26. What is stated in the passage about George Pullman?

A. He once had a job in a store. B. He always lived in Chicago.

C. He worked in a mine. D. He saved money for his project.

27. What is true about the sleeping cars?

A. The experimental models of sleeping cars had not been successful until 1863.

B. The Pioneer did not cost Pullman a fortune.

C. The Pioneer was considered to be the most charming cars in comparison with others.

D. The Pullman car was extremely beneficial because of its fitness through train station and bridges.

28. Why did the state of Illinois want to use the Pullman in Lincoln's funeral train?

A. It was superior to other cars.

B. It was the only railroad car that could make it from Springfield to Chicago.

C. Ulysses S. Grant requested it.

D. The Pullman Palace Car Company was a major Illinois business.

29. It can be inferred from the passage that the Michigan Central Railroad .....

A. was owned by George Pullman.

B. controlled the railroad tracks between Detroit and Chicago.

C. was the only railroad company to accommodate wider cars.

D. was the sole manufacturer of the Pioneer.

30. This passage would most likely be assigned in which of the following courses?

A. Engineering B. Political science C. Finance D. History

PASSAGE 4 – Questions 31-40

Garbage cans are not magical portals. Trash does not disappear when you toss it in a can. Yet, the average American throws away an estimated 1,600 pounds of waste each year. If there are no magic garbage fairies, where does all that trash go? There are four methods to managing waste: recycling, land-filling, composting, and incinerating. Each method has its strengths and weakness. Let's take a quick look at each.

Recycling is the process of turning waste into new materials. For example, used paper can be turned into paperboard, which can be used to make book covers. Recycling can reduce pollution, save materials, and lower energy use. Yet, some argue that recycling wastes energy. They believe that collecting, processing, and converting waste uses more energy than it saves. Still, most people agree that recycling is better for the planet than land-filling.

Land-filling is the oldest method of managing waste. In its simplest form, land-filling is when people bury garbage in a hole. Over time the practice of land-filling has advanced. Garbage is **compacted** before it is thrown into the hole. In this way more garbage can fit in each landfill. Large liners are placed in the bottom of landfills so that toxic garbage juice doesn't get into the ground water. Sadly, these liners don't always

work. Landfills may pollute the local water supply. Not to mention that all of that garbage stinks. Nobody wants to live next to a landfill. This makes it hard to find new locations for landfills.

As landfill space increases, interest in composting grows. Composting is when people pile up organic matter, such as food waste, and allows it to decompose. The product of this decomposition is compost. Compost can be added to the soil to make the soil richer and better for growing crops. While composting is easy to do onsite somewhere, like home or school, it's hard to do after the garbage gets all mixed up. This is because plastic and other inorganic materials must be removed from the compost pile or they will pollute the soil. There's a lot of plastic in garbage, which makes it hard to compost on a large scale.

One thing that is easier to do is burning garbage. There are two main ways to incinerate waste. The first is to create or harvest a fuel from the waste, such as methane gas, and burn the fuel. The second is to burn the waste directly. The heat from the **incineration** process can boil water, which can power steam generators. Unfortunately, burning garbage pollutes the air. Also, some critics worry that incinerators destroy valuable resources that could be recycled.

Usually, the community which you live manages waste. Once you put your garbage in that can, what happens to it is beyond your control. But you can make choices while it is still in your possession. You can choose to recycle, you can choose to compost, or you can choose to let someone else deal with it. The choice is yours.

31. Which best explains why the author begins the text by talking about magical garbage fairies?
    A. He is putting a common misconception to rest.
    B. He is trying to get the reader's attention.
    C. He is addressing his concern in a serious way.
    D. He is supporting his argument with evidence.

32. Which best expresses the meaning of the word **"compacted"** as it is used in the third paragraph?
    A. Garbage is burned before it is thrown in a hole.
    B. Garbage is put in trucks before it is thrown in a hole.
    C. Garbage is crushed smaller before it is thrown in a hole.
    D. Garbage is put in a can before it is thrown in a hole.

33. Which was **NOT** cited in the third paragraph as an issue with land-filling?
    A. Landfills are smelly.
    B. Usable materials are wasted in landfills.
    C. Landfills may pollute the water supply.
    D. It is difficult to find locations for landfills.

34. Which best expresses the main idea of the fourth paragraph?
    A. Landfills take up a lot of space.
    B. Composting is good for the soil but it can be.
    C. The process of composting is very complicated and scientific.
    D. There is a lot of plastic garbage in landfills.

35. Which best defines the meaning of **incineration** as it is used in the text?
    A. To bury waste materials in a large hole
    B. To allow waste products to decompose and become fertilizer
    C. To burn waste materials and harvest the energy
    D. To turn waste materials into products like book covers

36. Which conclusion could be supported with text from the passage?
    A. Each method of waste management has its drawbacks.
    B. Recycling is without a doubt the best way to handle waste.
    C. Incineration is the best way to process waste.
    D. All large cities should create massive compost piles.

37. Which best expresses the author's main purpose in writing this?
    A. To convince readers to recycle and compost
    B. To persuade readers that recycling is a waste of resources
    C. To compare and contrast recycling and land-filling
    D. To inform readers of methods of waste management

38. Which is **NOT** included in this text?
    A. A description of how trash is collected
    B. A description of the uses of compost
    C. A description of the two methods of incinerating trash
    D. A description of how landfills have advanced over time

39. Which best explains why composting is not feasible on a large scale?
    A. People wouldn't want to touch all of that gross rotting food.
    B. It would smell too bad in densely populated cities.
    C. It would attract rodents that would spread disease.
    D. Plastic would get into the compost and turn it into a pollutant.

40. Which title best expresses the main idea of this text?
    A. *The Magic of Recycling: Bringing Back What Was Once Lost*
    B. *Methods of Waste Management: Pros and Cons*
    C. *Recycling Land-filling or Composting: Which is Best For You?*
    D. *Do Your Part: How to Save the Earth by Recycling and Composting*